

OPPO Reno11 5G

New design, old innards

The OPPO Reno11 5G faces off against an array of popular mid-range smartphones in the Indian market. To stand out from the crowd, the company has almost tunnel-visioned on two aspects of their latest smartphones – design and camera. To that end, the OPPO Reno11 features a revamped design and a better 50-megapixel primary camera with OIS capabilities. Apart from these changes, OPPO has opted to retain most of the key specifications of the OPPO Reno10 and port them over to the Reno11. So, things like the display, battery, and processor remain pretty much unchanged. So, is the new OPPO Reno11 5G worth your money, or does it fall short of its competition in 2024? Let's find out.

₹29,999



BUILD AND DESIGN

The OPPO Reno11 5G has a bold design which is quite polarising. Unlike its predecessor, this version opts for a flashier aesthetic that might not be everyone's cup of tea. The rear panel, though made of plastic, mimics the appearance of glass with its glossy finish. However, this also means the rear panel is prone to attracting fingerprints and smudge marks. Personally, I find the matte finish of last year's Reno10 more premium-looking.

The revamped camera module, with its two circular housings for three lenses, appears slightly peculiar, especially with the flash placed outside. It seems like there's ample space within the module to accommodate it.

Aesthetics aside, the phone impresses with its slim and lightweight build. It felt incredibly comfortable to hold for extended periods. Weighing just 182 g and measuring only 8 mm thick, it boasts contours on both the display and rear panel for added comfort. Despite its



metal-like appearance, the frame is constructed from polycarbonate, which doesn't scuff easily but might be a tad flashy for some tastes.

The optical in-display fingerprint sensor is decent, but it's not the speediest.

The absence of an official IP rating could be a deal-

breaker for some. Overall, the OPPO Reno11 5G is a lightweight device with a striking appearance. It certainly attracts eyeballs, but whether you like the design or not will be based on your taste.

DISPLAY

The OPPO Reno11 5G has undergone a significant design overhaul, but its display remains unchanged. Sporting the familiar 6.7-inch Full HD+ AMOLED display from its predecessor, it continues to offer features like HDR10+ support and a 120 Hz refresh rate. With over 1 billion colours, it is a pretty commendable display in its price range.

The viewing angles are impressive, and the colours are vibrant. Its 3D curved screen enhances immersion,

achieving an 89.5 per cent screen-to-body ratio. However, my only gripe is its brightness. In a market where even mid-range smartphones excel in brightness, the Reno11 5G's 950 nits of peak brightness seem somewhat underwhelming.

During testing, I recorded a brightness of 842 nits in Auto Mode under bright sunlight. While respectable, it pales in comparison to competitors like the Redmi Note 13 Pro+, boasting a rated peak brightness of 1,800 nits. I also found the screen legibility on the lower side on particularly sunny days.

PERFORMANCE

Historically, OPPO phones haven't been the fastest on the block. The company focuses more on design and camera, and performance often feels overlooked. The same is true for the OPPO Reno11 5G. OPPO has fitted the Reno11 with the same 6 nm Dimensity 7050 processor as its predecessor, which is disappointing. Alongside, you get 8 GB of LPDDR4X RAM and 128 or 256 GB UFS 2.2 storage. In contrast, the Redmi Note 12 Pro+ which costs only ₹2,000 more comes with a much more powerful processor and faster UFS 3.1 storage.

The ramifications of this choice are clear when you put the phone through benchmarking tests. The OPPO Reno11 5G almost always scores lower than its similarly-priced competitors. In AnTuTu, the phone got a decent score of 540,116, however, the cheaper POCO X6 Pro absolutely blew the Reno11's score out of the water, as you can see below. The trend continued across GeekBench and PCMark Work as well.

The phone had low scores in GPU benchmarks such as 3D Mark Wild Life Extreme and GFXBench as well. The scores mimicked my experience in real life. I could play Call of Duty: Mobile and BGMI on this phone, but only on Low graphics. If I tried to switch to Medium graphics, I would be faced with a whole lot of lag and stutter, which honestly, isn't acceptable for a phone costing ₹30K.

If you're not a gamer and just want to use a phone for simple day-to-day